

PROPOSAL

**{Client Name}**

**{Engagement Name}**

**Prepared for:**

{Client Point of Contact}

**Prepared by:**

Stacy Berger + Jenna Shapiro



WOMEN'S BRAIN TRUST

HELLO!

Dear {Client Name},

All our best,

Stacy and Jenna



WOMEN'S BRAIN TRUST

**{Engagement Name}**



WOMEN'S BRAIN TRUST

## OVERVIEW & GOALS

Thank you for considering Women's Brain Trust to design and facilitate your upcoming team retreat. We want to support your priority for in-person time to connect, reflect, and move forward together, especially during a moment when being in relationship with one another matters deeply. Based on our conversations and the thinking you've already done, our key takeaways are that you want to:

- [Goal 1 — e.g., Connect as a team and feel grounded and ready for the work ahead]
- [Goal 2 — e.g., Strengthen trust and the team's collective capacity to navigate uncertainty]
- [Goal 3 — e.g., Align on priorities and how you'll work together in the year ahead]

The retreat is planned for two days:

**[Date 1]** and **[Date 2]**

Approximately **[#]** participants will attend.

The retreat will take place at **[Location]**.



## THE POWER OF A RETREAT

Most teams are deeply embedded in the daily grind. Over time, habits form: who speaks first, which topics feel risky, what gets avoided, how decisions really happen. From the inside, those patterns can be hard to see, let alone change.

A retreat creates the conditions to step out of autopilot. The team has room to interrupt familiar dynamics, access different ways of thinking, and see what's really happening beneath the surface. When that space is well-designed and well-held, it becomes possible to imagine new ways of working together.

Leaders often ask whether a facilitated retreat is worth the investment. We'd reframe the question: What does it cost not to address this? Unspoken tension, unclear roles, and eroding trust quietly drain energy and effectiveness over time. Intentional time together, guided by skilled facilitation, strengthens the relational infrastructure teams rely on to do their best work.

Time spent naming challenges, listening deeply, and working collaboratively toward improvement is rarely wasted. More often, it's the work teams wish they had done sooner.



# OUR DESIGN, FACILITATION, & FOLLOW-UP PROCESS

We create customized experiences by working alongside our clients to design a powerful plan for your time together.

## DISCOVERY & PLANNING

As we begin together,, we will:

- Collaborate to understand strategic priorities, develop a sense of your current team climate and functioning, and clarify retreat objectives.
- Conduct pre-retreat consultations with key stakeholders to surface context, challenges, and opportunities.
- Develop a comprehensive retreat agenda that aligns with your objectives, incorporate your feedback, and propose pre-retreat activities.

## FACILITATION

On the ground, we will:

- Facilitate an emotional and intellectual container to ensure participation, collaboration, and effective communication throughout the retreat days.
- Facilitate interactive sessions that encourage active participation and collaboration.
- Guide discussions, navigate complexity, and ensure all participants have meaningful opportunities to contribute.

## FOLLOW-UP

After the retreat, we will:

- Create and distribute a retreat evaluation to gather feedback and insights from participants.
- Analyze evaluation data and synthesize key themes to share back with you.
- Facilitate a post-retreat debrief conversation to share findings, discuss recommended next steps, and close our work together.



## OUR FACILITATION APPROACH

Facilitation is the practice of designing and guiding group conversations so people can think clearly together, surface what matters, and make progress on shared challenges. A facilitator is not there to provide answers or take sides, but instead to hold the process and create structure so teams can do their best collective thinking.

Our approach blends rigor with warmth. We center joy, humanity, and connection, and we don't turn away from tension or conflict when it shows up. We emphasize the importance of the relationships in the room, developing individual capacity for emotional intelligence, and remaining driven by purpose. We create space where teams can do the work they rarely have time, or permission, to do.

### Our facilitation helps teams:

- Name what's really happening. We help surface patterns, tensions, and assumptions that are shaping how the team works, including the things no one has quite figured out how to say out loud.
- Share responsibility for the work. Instead of placing the burden on the leader to manage every dynamic, facilitation invites collective ownership for how the team functions and moves forward.
- Move from insight to alignment. The goal isn't just reflection, it's clarity about shared priorities, agreements, and next steps, so progress doesn't evaporate once everyone returns to their daily grind.



## REFERENCES & CASE STUDIES

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**HOLD FOR CONTENT / THUMBNAIL IMAGES FROM NEW SITE!**



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# Fee Summary



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## {ENGAGEMENT NAME}

The fee structure that follows accounts for our time for two days of in-person facilitation, in addition to time for project management, planning, and follow-up. We will invoice for 50% of the overall cost at the start of this project, with the remaining balance invoiced after the retreat.

|                                                                                                                                                                            |                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Retreat Design + Facilitation</b><br>- All retreat-related planning (team meetings, stakeholder engagement, eval + analysis, follow-up, etc.)<br>- Retreat facilitation | <b>\$[X]</b>              |
| <b>Out-of-Pocket Expenses (estimated)</b><br>- 2 RT flights and/or train tickets<br>- 2 night hotel accommodation<br>- Travel to/from airport, transportation while onsite | <b>\$[X]</b>              |
| <b>Optional Add-Ons</b><br>- Prism Personality Assessments + 1:1 debriefs<br>- Stakeholder interviews / focus groups<br>- Pre-retreat office hours for participants        | TBD                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                            | TOTAL<br><b>\$[Total]</b> |



# About Us



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## ABOUT US

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WBT is a collaboration between Jenna Shapiro and Stacy Berger. We've worked as leaders in presidential campaigns, across all levels of school systems, at the senior leadership level of action-driven organizations including Planned Parenthood Federation of America, and alongside individuals and teams from the New York City Department of Education to Fair Fight in Georgia. We are passionate about doing work we love alongside people we respect. We partner with movement, government, and non-profit leaders - including at the DNC, Empower, and Emily's List - because we understand their unique challenges. Like them, we believe in the possibility of redesigning our social systems to interrupt inequity and build toward a more just future.



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# Thank you!

For questions about this proposal, contact:

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